

DESCRIPTION/SPECIFICATIONS/STATEMENT OF

WORK INTRODUCTION

The Bureau of Ocean Energy Management (BOEM) through the Marine Minerals Program has worked to identify sand resources across the Gulf of America (GOA). These resources are economically valuable because they are used in beach replenishment and other coastal protection and restoration projects. Recent studies have shown strong evidence that the offshore sand may contain concentrations of heavy and critical minerals, adding to its economic value. Locating sources of critical minerals in sediment resources in the GOA region and determining their concentrations could provide a secure and reliable supply of critical minerals related to our national security and economic prosperity.

The BOEM's intent with the request for information (RFI) is to find a vendor that can identify critical mineral deposits along the Texas Coast by analyzing 318 samples from 159 cores collected and are stored in Boca Raton, FL and Austin, TX. The goal of the project is to support BOEM's National Offshore Critical Mineral Inventory (NOCMI) to characterize critical mineral resources on the OCS. This proposed work aligns with President Trump's Executive Orders 14285, Unleashing America's Offshore Critical Minerals and Resources, and 14154, Unleashing American Energy, which prioritize unleashing America's potential to explore and develop OCS critical mineral resources. Furthermore, the work is in support of 30 CFR PART 581—Leasing of Marine Minerals other than oil, gas, or Sulphur in the Outer Continental Shelf.

SOURCES SOUGHT INFORMATION

BOEM/BSEE is issuing this RFI as part of market research in accordance with federal acquisition regulation (FAR) Part 10 to determine the availability and technical capability of sources proposing to identify critical mineral deposits along the Texas Coast by sampling these cores for critical minerals.

This Request for Information / Sources Sought Synopsis does not constitute an Invitation for Bids (IFB), a Request for Quote (RFQ), or a Request for Proposal (RFP) and it should not be construed as a commitment of any kind by the Government to issue a formal solicitation or ultimately award a contract. *The U.S. Government is in no way liable to pay for or reimburse any companies or entities that respond to this announcement. Any costs incurred by interested vendors in response to this announcement or incurred for participation in this market survey will NOT be reimbursed.* All information marked as proprietary information will be safeguarded to prevent disclosures to non-Government personnel and entities. There is no bid package or solicitation document associated with this announcement. Response to this RFI is strictly voluntary. NO SOLICITATION DOCUMENTS EXIST AT THIS TIME.

Restricted or proprietary components, interfaces and equipment, or **proprietary data** provided should be clearly marked and presented as an addendum to the non-restricted/non-proprietary information. In the absence of such identification BOEM will assume to have unlimited rights to all the technical data in the information paper.

BOEM is seeking information from vendors that have the capability of performing the work described below in the Objective and Scope. Responses must be identified by RFI No.

DOIMFBO260003 and the following information should be included in a cover letter to your response:

1. Company name
2. SAM.gov UEI number
3. Mailing address
4. E-mail address
5. Telephone number
6. Web site address (if available)
7. Business Size and Eligibility under U.S. Government socio-economic programs (i.e., type of business - large, small, small-disadvantaged, Woman-owned, veteran-owned, or 8(a)) under North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code associated with the project.
8. Confirm if your company is registered in the System for Award Management (SAM).
9. Any established pricing catalogs, rough of magnitudes or additional pricing information an interested party is willing to share regarding their products. This information would be for market research information only.
10. NAICS code recommendations for this scope (if any)

There is a ten (10) page limit to this response. **Responses should be submitted to:** bradford_kelly@ios.doi.gov

Based upon responses received, BOEM representatives may choose to meet (virtually) with

potential vendors and hold one-on-one exchanges. Such exchanges will be considered further Market Research intended to obtain clarifications of potential capability and/or experience to assist BOEM in defining and developing its requirements. While a response to this RFI is not mandatory, the likelihood of engaging in one-on-one exchanges may increase the likelihood of engaging these market research efforts with interested parties. **Any participation in these efforts will not be reimbursed.**

OBJECTIVE

The objective of this RFI is to identify vendors that have the capabilities to identify critical mineral deposits along the Texas OCS by conducting elemental/mineralogical analyses on 318 samples from 159 cores (Map and Core Locations in Appendices 1 below). The cores are in storage in Austin, TX and Boca Raton, FL. Elemental/mineralogical analyses should include basic testing to determine the elements found in the samples. Based on these results, select samples should be further processed through more specialized equipment to separate out the heavy minerals, calculate their distribution and mass, and determine their provenance, composition, and recoverability.

SCOPE

The vendor must have the ability to travel to Austin, TX and Boca Raton, FL where the cores are being stored, collecting samples from those cores, and conducting elemental / mineralogical analyses on those samples. Based on initial core descriptions, a minimum of 2 samples from each core should be identified prior to collection and discussed with BOEM geologists . Samples should be collected by an experienced geologist and shipped to the testing facility. Cores will remain in storage. All collected samples are to be run through grain size analysis using a Laser Particle Size Analysis (LPSA). All samples should be analyzed with an exploration style analysis to determine the elements in each sample. The analysis should be conducted on the relevant critical minerals in the Gulf of America from the final 2025 List of Critical Minerals, published to the Federal Register. After elemental analysis is completed, the need for additional testing will be discussed with BOEM. Specified samples should be analyzed to separate out the heavy minerals, calculate their distribution and mass, and determine their provenance, composition, and recoverability.

Appendix 1

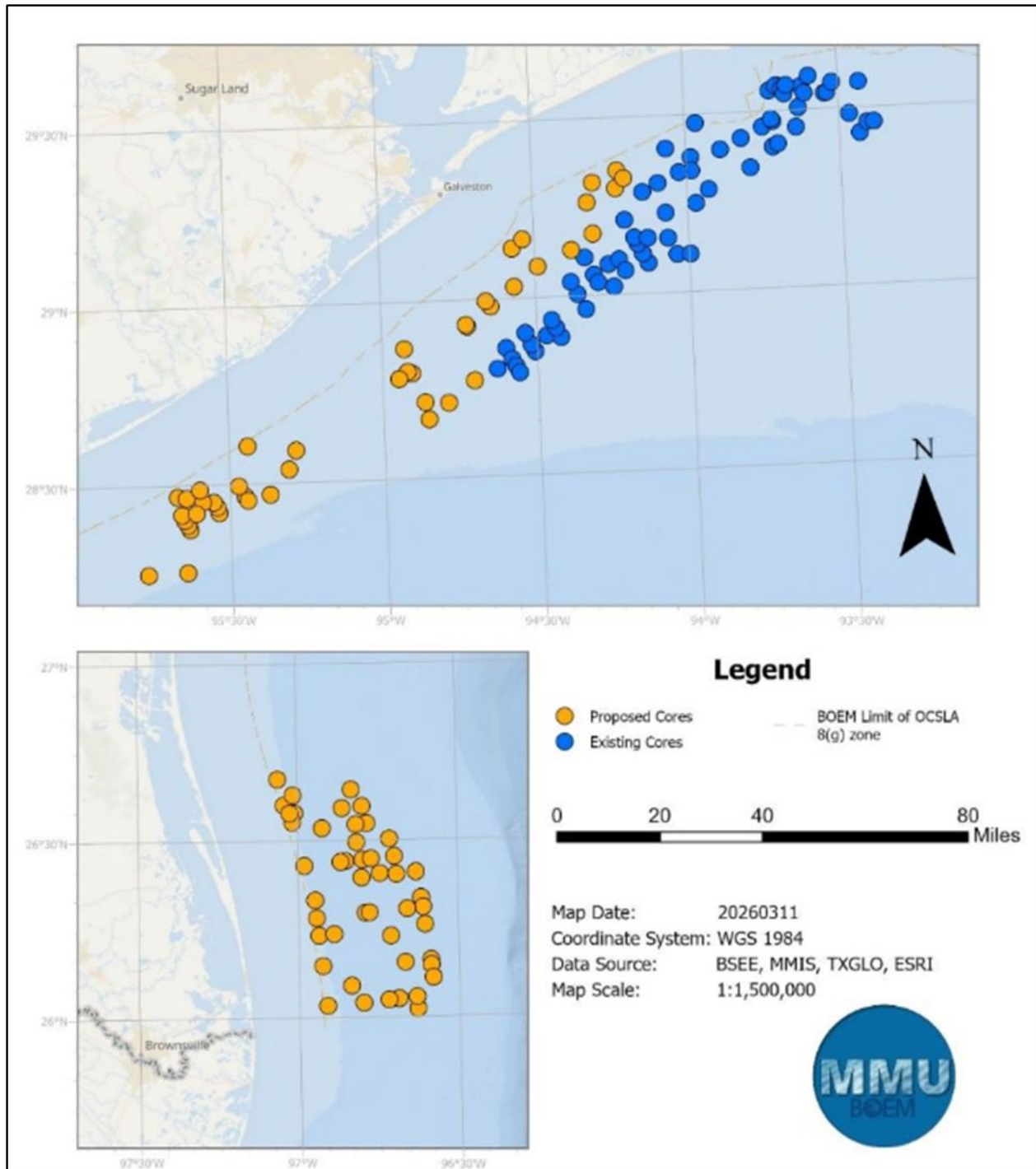


Table 1

Core Name	Existing/Proposed	Longitude	Latitude
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-01	Existing	-94.600936	28.861608
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-02	Existing	-94.630929	28.803581
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-03	Existing	-94.582719	28.83013
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-04	Existing	-94.570474	28.809904
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-05	Existing	-94.5591	28.790483
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-06	Existing	-94.508205	28.849211
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-07	Existing	-94.519271	28.868224
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-08	Existing	-94.538412	28.900953
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-09	Existing	-94.469195	28.891892
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-10	Existing	-94.42328	28.886237
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-11	Existing	-94.438873	28.913118
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-12	Existing	-94.4521	28.935765
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-13	Existing	-94.339483	28.962081
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-14	Existing	-94.364656	29.005266
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-15	Existing	-94.385271	29.040234
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-16	Existing	-94.339021	29.108178
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-17	Existing	-94.310045	29.058443
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-18	Existing	-94.297043	29.036087
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-19	Existing	-94.24692	29.023056
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-20	Existing	-94.262848	29.087246
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-21	Existing	-94.22756	29.099858
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-22	Existing	-94.208653	29.067792
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-23	Existing	-94.133372	29.085598
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-24	Existing	-94.149483	29.112684
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-25	Existing	-94.165657	29.140441
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-26	Existing	-94.176504	29.159406
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-27	Existing	-94.132262	29.156532
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-28	Existing	-94.066996	29.154516
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-29	Existing	-94.039218	29.106894
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-30	Existing	-93.996204	29.106511
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-31	Existing	-93.723049	29.557474
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-32	Existing	-93.699528	29.571003
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-33	Existing	-93.701836	29.569952
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-34	Existing	-93.682165	29.560475
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-35	Existing	-93.674835	29.548111
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-36	Existing	-93.887484	29.397446
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-37	Existing	-93.983904	29.379341
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-38	Existing	-93.98346	29.341362
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-39	Existing	-94.024511	29.338578

GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-40	Existing	-94.09363	29.310208
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-41	Existing	-94.206086	29.209708
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-42	Existing	-94.071276	29.225361
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-43	Existing	-94.144396	29.287048
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-44	Existing	-93.97265	29.249304
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-45	Existing	-93.929707	29.286334
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-46	Existing	-93.792066	29.344032
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-47	Existing	-93.717297	29.399558
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-48	Existing	-93.700328	29.40713
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-49	Existing	-93.640543	29.451815
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-50	Existing	-93.630242	29.507424
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-51	Existing	-94.06423	29.406504
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-57	Existing	-93.965143	29.475649
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-59	Existing	-93.819459	29.427706
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-60	Existing	-93.750302	29.456359
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-61	Existing	-93.714621	29.47148
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-62	Existing	-93.719725	29.477459
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-63	Existing	-93.621124	29.566147
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-64	Existing	-93.667193	29.571369
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-65	Existing	-93.594779	29.594495
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-66	Existing	-93.610278	29.54776
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-67	Existing	-93.54422	29.544106
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-68	Existing	-93.537179	29.547121
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-69	Existing	-93.519014	29.574736
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-70	Existing	-93.432566	29.572973
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-71	Existing	-93.466652	29.484444
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-72	Existing	-93.434461	29.428508
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-73	Existing	-93.409471	29.45926
GLO-UPOCS-VC-24-74	Existing	-93.388039	29.45936
VC_087	Proposed	-97.061251	26.675344
VC_091	Proposed	-97.041578	26.601484
VC_093	Proposed	-97.024225	26.577719
VC_095	Proposed	-97.015783	26.552546
VC_097	Proposed	-97.013227	26.630405
VC_100	Proposed	-97.008801	26.578992
VC_104	Proposed	-96.979503	26.430396
VC_107	Proposed	-96.947373	26.332378
VC_108	Proposed	-96.944088	26.282118
VC_109	Proposed	-96.936482	26.231678
VC_110	Proposed	-96.922284	26.535936
VC_111	Proposed	-96.926095	26.146681

VC_112	Proposed	-96.912324	26.033419
VC_113	Proposed	-96.890291	26.236444
VC_114*	Proposed	-96.866129	26.439907
VC_115	Proposed	-96.858873	26.591519
VC_117	Proposed	-96.851815	26.441036
VC_118	Proposed	-96.832094	26.644117
VC_119	Proposed	-96.837618	26.089684
VC_120	Proposed	-96.817671	26.544588
VC_121	Proposed	-96.815928	26.494279
VC_122	Proposed	-96.800969	26.394856
VC_123	Proposed	-96.797629	26.596567
VC_124	Proposed	-96.79734	26.445573
VC_125	Proposed	-96.800283	26.041831
VC_126	Proposed	-96.789684	26.295038
VC_127	Proposed	-96.782585	26.54749
VC_128	Proposed	-96.778298	26.295976
VC_129	Proposed	-96.771185	26.447662
VC_130	Proposed	-96.744336	26.406675
VC_131	Proposed	-96.720953	26.048918
VC_132	Proposed	-96.712334	26.502739
VC_133	Proposed	-96.712039	26.229835
VC_134	Proposed	-96.699	26.453578
VC_135	Proposed	-96.690888	26.40386
VC_136	Proposed	-96.689736	26.051466
VC_137	Proposed	-96.668724	26.153903
VC_138	Proposed	-96.659724	26.305653
VC_139	Proposed	-96.630763	26.408705
VC_140	Proposed	-96.633414	26.056077
VC_141	Proposed	-96.631176	26.023752
VC_142	Proposed	-96.615449	26.336908
VC_143	Proposed	-96.609765	26.309702
VC_144	Proposed	-96.604349	26.260989
VC_145	Proposed	-96.588187	26.160491
VC_146	Proposed	-96.586608	26.146483
VC_147	Proposed	-96.581314	26.110696
VC_037	Proposed	-94.919955	28.804207
VC_039	Proposed	-94.947892	28.784381
VC_054	Proposed	-95.440736	28.607517
VC_057	Proposed	-95.543171	28.437063
VC_064	Proposed	-95.638128	28.3879
VC_066	Proposed	-95.647295	28.402584

VC_058	Proposed	-95.553373	28.451264
VC_069	Proposed	-95.656363	28.417242
VC_061	Proposed	-95.588569	28.451971
VC_063	Proposed	-95.609851	28.421248
VC_038	Proposed	-94.929376	28.868397
VC_071	Proposed	-95.668659	28.46846
VC_065	Proposed	-95.640128	28.46382
VC_062	Proposed	-95.596818	28.486559
VC_056	Proposed	-95.472076	28.494603
VC_046	Proposed	-95.285706	28.591448
VC_032	Proposed	-95.451977	28.46628
VC_029	Proposed	-95.371099	28.469289
VC_002	Proposed	-94.225108	29.350638
VC_010	Proposed	-94.490711	29.087406
VC_015	Proposed	-94.646515	28.979543
VC_018	Proposed	-94.724302	28.925526
VC_017	Proposed	-94.704661	28.772668
VC_003	Proposed	-94.231282	29.300438
VC_006	Proposed	-94.305685	29.318986
VC_007	Proposed	-94.325237	29.263533
VC_005	Proposed	-94.309149	29.17442
VC_008	Proposed	-94.380394	29.131294
VC_013	Proposed	-94.572606	29.141572
VC_011	Proposed	-94.536444	29.166622
VC_016	Proposed	-94.661593	28.99489
VC_019	Proposed	-94.729016	28.930285
VC_031	Proposed	-95.443484	28.454355
VC_034	Proposed	-95.630054	28.375001
VC_036	Proposed	-95.768162	28.249052
VC_027	Proposed	-94.906283	28.798646
VC_033	Proposed	-95.53704	28.420908
VC_028	Proposed	-95.309725	28.539197
VC_022	Proposed	-94.7913	28.712338
VC_012	Proposed	-94.568575	29.033589
VC_001	Proposed	-94.203444	29.32849
VC_025	Proposed	-94.855541	28.667456
VC_026	Proposed	-94.865906	28.715895
VC_035	Proposed	-95.641047	28.255005